

When I first came on duty, Brigade reported that some Iraqis had stolen a cargo-type HMMWV, and they had no idea where they were. How would you like to be the guy who let that happen? No one could even figure out where the HMMWV came from or how the Iraqis got a hold of it in the first place. All I know is that somehow there were supposed to be twenty Iraqis riding around Baghdad in a cargo HMMWV. Ludicrous!

Additionally, the body count for American soldiers in Iraq continues to rise. A military ambulance was ambushed this afternoon by guerilla forces using AK-47s and RPGs. This happened south of us near one of our main supply bases, LSA Dogwood. Apparently the ambulance was caught at a chokepoint on the supply route and the fire came from behind the brick walls that lined both sides of the road in the area. I can't quite picture it since I have never been there and I don't know exactly where the attack occurred. Either way, the attack continues a trend of attacks on US forces and loss of American lives that is troubling. In the last week, we have lost nearly one soldier per day. It's difficult for me to believe that we continue to lose so many people since the "war" is supposed to be over.

This afternoon we overheard another, similar report. One of our helicopter support units was conducting a training exercise around the city and when they attempted to return to home station, two of the Kiowa Warriors were fired upon by gunmen using AK-47s. Luckily an AK won't do too much damage to a chopper and no one was hurt. Just another incident, just another reason for us to be here forever.

On a brighter note, some UN forces have arrived in the area today and they will begin to help with the peace keeping mission. We will get some Estonian soldiers—30 to 40—to help us in our sector. Other units will have Polish soldiers. This is a positive sign for us since it is the first sign of anyone coming to assist or relieve us. We all just want to go home.

I love you and miss you both (or should I say all three of you) very much.

Love,

A handwritten signature in cursive script, appearing to read "Christian".

Christian